

SINCE TAKE OFF

THE AIRLINE,
NATIONALISED
72 YEARS AGO,
IS LOOKING TO
RECLAIM ITS
GLORY DAYS
UNDER JRD TATA,
WHO REMAINED
ITS CHAIRMAN FOR
25 LONG YEARS
AFTER THE
TAKEOVER BY THE
GOVERNMENT



PRE-PRIVATISATION ERA (1932-2021)

- **1932** J.R.D. Tata establishes Tata Airlines as India's first carrier, operating a single de Havilland Puss Moth between Karachi and Bombay
- **1946** Post-WW-II transformation into Air India as a public limited company
- **1948** Launch of international service (Bombay-London), marking India's entry into global aviation
- **1953** The Centre nationalises Air India through the Air Corporations Act, taking control from Tata Sons



- **1994** Aviation sector liberalisation allows private competitors

COMPETITION AND DECLINE (1994-2021)



- **1970s-1980s** J.R.D. Tata served as Chairman (1953-1977), then Ratan Tata briefly (1986-1989)
- **1962** Name simplified from Air-India International to Air India
- **1953-1994** Air India enjoys a domestic monopoly under state control

GOVERNMENT ERA (1953-1994)

entertainment. It has also invested US\$200 million to revamp its entire IT infrastructure, replacing old systems. The airline is also setting up an aviation training academy in Gurugram for pilots, cabin crew, engineers, and ground staff, a flying training unit in Maharashtra, and an aircraft maintenance training insti-

tute in Hyderabad. Additionally, it is in the process of setting up an MRO facility in Bengaluru to handle both narrowbody and widebody aircraft.

"The impact of the crash has been severe on AI, both financially and non-financially. However, it is regrouping fast and expects normalisation by October 1," says

Kapil Kaul, the CEO of aviation consultancy firm CAPA India.

MESSY OPERATIONS

But a revival is easier said than done. The airline's poor financial performance shows that it will take much longer to turn around. In FY25, the Air India Group posted losses of